A CALMER GIFTING PRINTABLE

Holiday-Week Checklist

The holiday week is famous for being wonderful and exhausting at the same time. This checklist spreads the work across seven days and — just as important — schedules the rest, the water, and the deep breaths too.

How to use it

1. Stick it on the fridge the weekend before the holiday. That's it — that's the setup.
2. Do the small things early so the last days stay human-sized.
3. Check boxes as you go. Skipping a box is also a valid choice; this list is a servant, not a boss.
4. Notice that every day includes something kind for *you*. That's on purpose.
5. Page 3 is the safety net: the “if it doesn't get done” page. Read it without guilt.

What's inside

- **Page 2** — a week before, 2–3 days before, and the day before.
- **Page 3** — the day of, the day after, and the calm kit.

> **A kind note:** guests remember the feeling of the day, not the fingerprint-free baseboards. If the choice is between one more task and one more laugh — you know which box to leave unchecked.

Print at 100% (“Actual size”), US Letter, portrait. Prints nicely in black & white. Personal use: print as many copies as you like.

Holiday-Week Checklist

Little steps early, gentle days late. Boxes are suggestions; calm is the goal.

A week before

- [ ] Confirm who's coming, when, and any food needs.
- [ ] Write the menu (keep one “easy night” in it).
- [ ] Order or buy anything that ships — today, not later.
- [ ] Wrap what's already in the house.
- [ ] Check cards, stamps, tape, batteries, and wrapping paper.
- [ ] Do one 15-minute tidy of the room guests will see.
- [ ] Plan something kind for you this week.

2–3 days before

- [ ] Grocery run — with the list, not from memory.
- [ ] Cook or prep anything that freezes or keeps.
- [ ] Set the table early if it helps you breathe.
- [ ] Finish last cards and mail them.
- [ ] Charge cameras, phones, and tablets.
- [ ] Go to bed on time. Seriously — it's on the list.

The day before

- [ ] Set out serving dishes and label them with sticky notes.
- [ ] Chill drinks, thaw anything from the freezer.
- [ ] Last wrap-and-tag session; hide the scissors after.
- [ ] Tidy the entryway and the bathroom. That's enough.
- [ ] Lay out clothes for tomorrow, including comfy socks.
- [ ] Stop by 9 p.m. The list will wait. You shouldn't.

The Day Of & The Day After

The day of: be present. The day after: be gentle. Both count as success.

The day of

- [ ] Eat a real breakfast before anyone arrives.
- [ ] Music on, lights warm, phone on a shelf.
- [ ] Put one person in charge of drinks, one of the door.
- [ ] Serve the food a little imperfect and a lot warm.
- [ ] Sit down for the meal — you're a guest at your own table.
- [ ] Take one photo of the people, not just the food.
- [ ] Accept every offer of help with “yes, please.”

The day after

- [ ] Leftovers for dinner — cooking is cancelled.
- [ ] Write any last thank-you notes (templates sheet helps).
- [ ] Note what worked and what didn't for next year.
- [ ] Pack decorations without judging yourself for any of it.
- [ ] Take a real walk or a real nap. You've earned both.

The calm kit (gather it in advance)

Spare gift or two • spare card • tape & scissors • batteries • a joke or story for awkward pauses • snacks for the chef • a quiet room you're allowed to escape to.

If it doesn't get done: the holiday still happens — warm lights, full table, people you love. Anything unchecked on this list is a candidate for next year, not a verdict on this one.